BESSEM KORTAS

Senior Software Engineer | Frontend Team Lead | Full-Stack Capable

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PROFILE

Senior Software Engineer with 7+ years in banking, insurance, and fintech platforms, and Frontend Team Lead since 2023. I specialize in frontend architecture — React, React Native, Angular, TypeScript — and in building design systems and SDKs. One of these has been rolled out across 5+ banking projects so far, cutting delivery time by around 30% based on an internal cost analysis. I'm also building out my full-stack range through personal projects in Node.js/Express, NestJS, and Spring Boot, and I have working knowledge of Docker and Kubernetes.

As Team Lead, I own architecture proposals, implementation decisions, and code/merge review for a multi-application banking product. I also handle a lot of the delivery side: breaking user stories into estimated tasks with the team, running sprint planning and review, coordinating the handoff to QA, and defining CI/CD stages with DevOps. Beyond my own team, I support other departments that integrate the product for their clients, and I run onboarding workshops for new engineers joining the project.

I use AI-assisted tools day to day (GitHub Copilot, Claude Code), including structuring context and skills to get better results with less token usage. Longer term, I'm working toward a broader full-stack role and, eventually, a technical leadership position where I can combine hands-on engineering with more say in business and management decisions.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Frontend Team Lead — Proxym

2023 — Present

R&D department (Bankerise product) — leading a frontend team of 4 to 10 engineers, and supporting 3 client-integration departments (3–4 teams each) on request.

- Kept architecture and code quality consistent across 4 separate apps (end-user, bank-agent, admin dashboard, business), by owning architecture proposals, implementation decisions, and code/merge review for the Bankerise product.
- Got management buy-in on every major architecture change, by building and presenting the technical case ahead of each critical decision.
- Kept sprints estimated and unblocked, by breaking user stories into technical tasks with the team and clarifying open questions directly with Business Analysts and the design team.
- Shipped releases without QA or DevOps bottlenecks, by coordinating QA handoff and defining CI/CD pipeline stages, including writing the GitLab CI scripts.
- Cut new-engineer ramp-up time, by running onboarding workshops on the product's architecture and what each of the four applications does.
- Cut delivery time by roughly 30%, measured by a post-delivery person-day cost analysis, by rolling out a modular design-system SDK (theming, tokens, dark/light mode) across 5+ banking projects.
- Drove reuse across ~12 banking projects plus several non-banking ones, by publishing internal SDKs to Nexus, including cross-domain SDKs for analytics and HTTP request handling.
- Made the platform usable across 3 sectors (retail, corporate, microfinance) without separate codebases, by designing a configurable platform layer and helping introduce a new API Gateway with reworked error-handling.
- Closed a security gap on banking APIs, by implementing Keycloak authentication, request-signing to confirm calls come from a trusted device or app, and Facia AI for OCR and facial-recognition checks.

Technical environment: React, React Native, TypeScript, Redux Saga, Zustand, Node.js (mock services), Chakra UI, Keycloak, API Gateway, GitLab CI.

Senior Software Engineer — Proxym

09/2019 — 2023

Individual-contributor stage prior to Team Lead promotion — banking, insurance, and corporate-banking client engagements.

- Digitized customer-request handling for bank agents, measured by faster processing and fewer client/branch back-and-forths, by leading a 5-developer team to build an agent dashboard, journey tracking, and a 360° customer view.
- Enabled automated, repeatable builds and deployments, by defining the CI/CD pipeline scripts and stages with DevOps.
- Simplified dependency management on a large frontend codebase, by migrating it from Angular to React and from a multi-repo setup to a monorepo (Nx + Lerna).
- Made data flows predictable and centralized identity management, by introducing Redux Saga for state management and leading the move to Keycloak for authentication.
- Replaced inconsistent legacy styling across the app, by adopting Chakra UI as the primary design system.

- Delivered 2 banking modules — transfers and beneficiary management — for a corporate digital-banking application (Barwa Bank / Dukhan Bank), by collaborating remotely with the client's core-banking team in Qatar on integration and deployment.
- Cut appointment conflicts across multiple agencies, by building a centralized FullCalendar-based scheduling platform.
- Improved state-management practices and extended reach to mobile, by recommending and helping implement NGRX adoption, then extracting an Android/iOS version via Cordova.

Technical environment: Angular, React, TypeScript, NGRX, Redux Saga, Chakra UI, Keycloak, Cordova, Storybook, Jest, Cypress, SonarQube, Husky, CommitLint.

Software Developer — ENVAST *02/2019 — 07/2019*

- Improved accessibility for students aged 6–12, by leading the integration of a mobile app into a gamified web platform for students, parents, and teachers.

Intern — Alt Tab Studio *07/2018 — 08/2018*

- Contributed to a working to-do web application as part of a small development team.

PERSONAL PROJECTS — FULL-STACK

Self-directed projects built outside professional engagements to develop hands-on backend and full-stack range.

Real-time chat application *(2020)*

- Built a working real-time messaging app, by combining a React frontend with a Node.js/Express + WebSocket backend and MongoDB for persistence.

Task-management application (Jira-style) *(2021)*

- Delivered a complete task-management tool solo, by building task creation/assignment, estimation, sprints, and status tracking with Spring Boot and React.

Vehicle-dashboard application *(2022)*

- Shipped a vehicle-dashboard app as part of a 3-developer team, by owning the frontend build with NestJS and Angular.

Also explored containerization for personal projects — building Docker images and learning Kubernetes fundamentals (ingress configuration, ArgoCD dashboard, pod/log inspection).

SKILLS

Frontend: React.js, React Native, Angular, TypeScript, JavaScript, HTML5, CSS3, Tailwind CSS, Chakra UI, Taiga UI

Architecture & State Management: Design Systems, SDK Development, Micro Frontend Concepts, Redux Saga, NgRx, Zustand

Mobile: React Native, Cordova, Capacitor, Android/iOS build configuration

Backend (hands-on via personal projects): Node.js, Express.js, WebSocket, NestJS, Spring Boot, REST APIs, MongoDB

Security & Identity: Keycloak, API request signing / device-trust verification, Facia AI (OCR, facial recognition)

Testing & Quality: Jest, Cypress, Puppeteer, Storybook, SonarQube

DevOps & Tools: Docker, Kubernetes (working knowledge), CI/CD (GitLab CI), GitHub, NGINX, Nexus Repository

Enterprise Platforms: Keycloak, Flowable BPMN, Formio.js

AI-Assisted Development: GitHub Copilot, Claude Code — context/skill design, prompt structuring, token-usage optimization

EDUCATION

2022 — National Diploma in Software Engineering, EPI – International Multidisciplinary School

2019 — Bachelor's Degree in Computer Sciences, Higher Institute of Applied Sciences and Technology

2016 — High School Degree in Computer Sciences, Ali Bourguiba High School

LANGUAGES

English · **French** · **Arabic**